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Endoscopic interspinous insert

Abstract

Disclosed is an endoscopic interspinous insert capable of being inserted into a body through an incision hole during a spinal endoscopic operation. The endoscopic interspinous insert includes a first support member including a first support body configured to support any one of the adjacent spinous processes, and a plurality of first support protrusions protruding from two opposite ends of the first support body, a second support member including a second support body configured to support the other of the adjacent spinous processes, and a plurality of second support protrusions protruding from two opposite ends of the second support body, and an adjustment member disposed between the first support member and the second support member and configured to adjust a distance between the first support member and the second support member.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) This application is a National Stage filing under 35 U.S.C. 371 of International Application No. PCT/KR2021/005646, filed on May 6, 2021, which claims the benefit of earlier filing date and right of priority to Korean Application No. 10-2020-0054196, filed on May 7, 2020 in the Korean Intellectual Property Office, the contents of which are all hereby incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

BACKGROUND OF THE DISCLOSURE

Technical Field

(2) The present invention relates to an interspinous insert, and more particularly, to an interspinous insert used for a spinal operation using an endoscope.

Background Art

(3) To solve the instability of spinal segments after discectomy or posterior decompression, interspinous spacer implantation is performed by inserting an interspinous spacer between a patient's spinous processes.

(4) The interspinous spacer implantation includes processes of incising a predetermined section of a surgical site, inserting a spacer between adjacent spinous processes through the incised portion, surrounding the spinous processes with a strap or band, and fixing the spacer between the spinous processes.

(5) Recently, even in the case of the interspinous spacer implantation, methods are being studied to form several incision holes at a periphery of a surgical site, insert an endoscope and surgical tools through the incision holes, and fix an interspinous spacer without incising a predetermined section of a surgical site.

(6) However, because a size of the interspinous spacer in the related art is larger than a size of the incision hole, there is a problem in that the interspinous spacer cannot pass through the incision hole.

RELATED PATENT DOCUMENT

(7) (Patent Document 1) Korean Patent No. 10-1661635

SUMMARY OF THE DISCLOSURE

(8) The present invention has been made in an effort to solve the above-mentioned problem, and an object of the present invention is to provide an endoscopic interspinous insert capable of being inserted into a body through an incision hole during a spinal endoscopic operation.

(9) Technical problems of the present invention are not limited to the aforementioned technical problems, and other technical problems, which are not mentioned above, may be clearly understood by those skilled in the art from the following descriptions.

(10) To achieve the above-mentioned object, an endoscopic interspinous insert according to an embodiment of the present invention may be configured to be inserted between adjacent spinous processes and include: a first support member including a first support body configured to support any one of the adjacent spinous processes, and a plurality of first support protrusions protruding from two opposite ends of the first support body; a second support member including a second support body configured to support the other of the adjacent spinous processes, and a plurality of second support protrusions protruding from two opposite ends of the second support body; and an adjustment member disposed between the first support member and the second support member and configured to adjust a distance between the first support member and the second support member.

(11) The first support member may be disposed at a first position at which the first support member overlaps the second support member or a second position at which the first support member is separated from the second support member and spaced apart from the second support member at a predetermined distance.

(12) The adjustment member may be integrated with at least one of the first support member and the second support member.

(13) The first support member may include a first frame having a first accommodation portion configured to accommodate one end of the adjustment member, and the second support member may include a second frame having a second accommodation portion configured to accommodate the other end of the adjustment member.

(14) The adjustment member may include: a cylindrical adjustment body; and a plurality of adjustment side teeth protruding from an outer peripheral surface of the adjustment body, and the first and second frames may include a plurality of frame side teeth configured to engage with the plurality of adjustment side teeth.

(15) The plurality of adjustment side teeth may each include first and second inclined surfaces having different inclination angles.

(16) The adjustment member may include a compression spring.

(17) The endoscopic interspinous insert may further include: a locking member configured to fix the first support member to the second support member to prevent the first support member from being separated from the second support member.

(18) The locking member may include: a hook coupled to the first support member; and a catching portion coupled to the second support member and configured such that a part of the hook is inserted into the catching portion.

(19) The adjustment member may be rotatably disposed between the first support member and the second support member.

(20) The endoscopic interspinous insert may further include: a locking member configured to maintain a distance between the first support member and the second support member and restrict movements of the first and second support members, in which the locking member includes: a first locking block inserted into the adjustment member; a second locking block inserted between the first support member and the second support member; a connection flange configured to connect the first locking block and the second locking block; and a fixing screw configured to be fixed to the adjustment member while penetrating the first locking block and the second locking block.

(21) The adjustment member may include: a screw bevel gear rotatably disposed in the second support member and coupled to the first support member; and an adjustment bevel gear configured to transmit power to the screw bevel gear.

(22) The first support member may include a first adjustment groove, the second support member may include a second adjustment groove, and the adjustment member may be screw-coupled to the first adjustment groove and the second adjustment groove.

(23) The endoscopic interspinous insert may further include: a locking member configured to maintain a distance between the first support member and the second support member and restrict

movements of the first and second support members.

(24) According to the embodiment of the present invention, the endoscopic interspinous insert may be inserted into the body through the incision hole and then deformed in the body to have a shape suitable for a surgical operation, which makes it possible to perform the surgical operation through the incision hole without incising a predetermined section of a surgical site.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIGS. 1A and 1B are views illustrating a process of spreading an endoscopic interspinous insert according to an embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 1C is a cross-sectional view taken along line B-B in FIG. 1B, and FIG. 1D is a view illustrating a process of spreading the endoscopic interspinous insert according to the embodiment of the present invention.

(2) FIGS. 2A, 2B, and 2C are views illustrating a process of disposing the endoscopic interspinous insert according to the embodiment of the present invention between spinous processes.

(3) FIG. 3A is a cross-sectional view taken along line A-A in FIG. 1B, and FIG. 3B is a view illustrating a process of adjusting a distance between a first frame and a second frame.

(4) FIG. 4A is a cross-sectional view of a first frame, a second frame, and an adjustment member of an endoscopic interspinous insert according to another embodiment of the present invention, and FIG. 4B is a side view of the second frame and the adjustment member of the endoscopic interspinous insert according to the embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 4C is a view illustrating a process of adjusting a distance between the first frame and the second frame.

(5) FIG. 5A is a cross-sectional view of a first frame, a second frame, and an adjustment member of an endoscopic interspinous insert according to still another embodiment of the present invention, and FIG. 5B is a side view of the second frame of the endoscopic interspinous insert according to the embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 5C is a view illustrating a process of adjusting a distance between the first frame and the second frame, and FIG. 5D is a view illustrating a state in which the first frame and the second frame are locked by a locking member.

(6) FIG. 6A is a front view illustrating the locking member, and FIG. 6B is a top plan view of a first locking block and a bottom plan view of a second locking block. FIG. 6C is a cross-sectional view illustrating the locking member, and FIG. 6D is a view illustrating a state in which the locking member and the adjustment member are coupled by a fixing screw.

(7) FIG. 7A is a top plan view of a first frame, a second frame, and an adjustment member of an endoscopic interspinous insert according to yet another embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 7B is a side view of the first frame, the second frame, and the adjustment member of the endoscopic interspinous insert according to the embodiment of the present invention. FIGS. 7C and 7D are views illustrating a process of adjusting a distance between the first frame and the second frame.

(8) FIG. 8A is a top plan view of a first frame, a second frame, and an adjustment member of an endoscopic interspinous insert according to still yet another embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 8B is a side view of the second frame of the endoscopic interspinous insert according to the embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 8C is a cross-sectional view taken along line C-C in FIG. 8A. FIG. 8D is a view illustrating a process of adjusting a distance between the first frame and the second frame.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENT

(9) Hereinafter, various exemplary embodiments will be described in more detail with reference to the accompanying drawings. The exemplary embodiments disclosed in the present specification may be variously modified. Specific embodiments will be illustrated in the drawings and described in detail in the detailed description. However, the specific embodiments illustrated in the

accompanying drawings are merely intended to facilitate understanding of various embodiments. Therefore, the technical spirit is not limited by the specific embodiments illustrated in the accompanying drawings, and the scope of the present invention should be understood as including all equivalents or substitutes included in the spirit and technical scope of the present invention.

(10) The terms including ordinal numbers such as ‘first,’ ‘second,’ and the like may be used to describe various constituent elements, but the constituent elements are not limited by the terms. These terms are used only to distinguish one constituent element from another constituent element.

(11) In the present specification, it should be understood the terms “comprises,” “comprising,” “includes,” “including,” “containing,” “has,” “having” or other variations thereof are inclusive and therefore specify the presence of stated features, integers, steps, operations, elements, components, or combinations thereof, but do not preclude the presence or addition of one or more other features, integers, steps, operations, elements, components, or combinations thereof. When one constituent element is described as being “coupled” or “connected” to another constituent element, it should be understood that one constituent element can be coupled or connected directly to another constituent element, and an intervening constituent element can also be present between the constituent elements. When one constituent element is described as being “coupled directly to” or “connected directly to” another constituent element, it should be understood that no intervening constituent element is present between the constituent elements.

(12) Meanwhile, the term “module” or “unit” used for a constituent element used in the present specification performs at least one function or operation. Further, the “module” or “unit” may perform the function or operation by hardware, software, or a combination of hardware and software. In addition, except for the “module” or “unit” that should be performed in specific hardware or performed by at least one processor, a plurality of “modules” or a plurality of “units” may be integrated into at least one module. Singular expressions include plural expressions unless clearly described as different meanings in the context.

(13) In addition, in the description of the present invention, the specific descriptions of related well-known functions or configurations will be summarized or omitted when it is determined that the specific descriptions may unnecessarily obscure the subject matter of the present invention.

(14) FIGS. 1A and 1B are views illustrating a process of spreading an endoscopic interspinous insert according to an embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 1C is a cross-sectional view taken along line B-B in FIG. 1B, and FIG. 1D is a view illustrating a process of spreading the endoscopic interspinous insert according to the embodiment of the present invention. To help understand the present invention, FIG. 1C additionally illustrates cross-sections of spinous processes between which the interspinous insert is inserted.

(15) FIGS. 2A, 2B, and 2C are views illustrating a process of disposing the endoscopic interspinous insert according to the embodiment of the present invention between spinous processes.

(16) FIG. 3A is a cross-sectional view taken along line A-A in FIG. 1B, and FIG. 3B is a view illustrating a process of adjusting a distance between a first frame and a second frame.

(17) Referring to FIGS. 1A to 3B, an endoscopic interspinous insert **100** according to the embodiment of the present invention includes a first support member **110**, a second support member **120**, and an adjustment member **130**.

(18) The first support member **110** is configured to come into contact with at least a part of an outer surface of any one **S1** of adjacent spinous processes. The first support member **110** includes a first support body **112**, a plurality of first support protrusions **114**, a first frame **116**, and a first insertion groove **118**.

(19) The first support body **112** may support any one **S1** of the spinous processes in a state in which the endoscopic interspinous insert **100** is inserted between the adjacent spinous processes **S1** and **S2**. The first support body **112** may be made of rubber or silicone. In addition, the first support body **112** may be made of various materials having an elastic force.

(20) The first support body **112** may include a first contact surface **112a** configured to come into contact with at least a part of the outer surface of any one **S1** of the spinous processes.

(21) The first contact surface **112a** may have a shape corresponding to at least a part of the outer surface of any one **S1** of the spinous processes. The first contact surface **112a** may have a mesh structure having relatively higher surface roughness than the other parts of the first support body **112**.

(22) Because the first contact surface **112a** has the mesh structure, a frictional force, which occurs when the first contact surface **112a** comes into contact with the spinous process **S1**, may prevent the first contact surface **112a** from slipping from the surface of the spinous process **S1**, such that the interspinous insert **100** may be stably fixed while being disposed between the spinous processes **S1** and **S2**.

(23) The plurality of first support protrusions **114** protrudes from two opposite ends of the first support body **112**. Any one **114a** of the plurality of first support protrusions **114** may extend from one end of the first contact surface **112a**, and the other **114b** of the plurality of first support protrusions **114** may extend from the other end of the first contact surface **112a**. The plurality of first support protrusions **114** may each have a rounded shape to surround the outer surface of any one **S1** of the spinous processes. In the state in which the interspinous insert **100** is disposed between the spinous processes **S1** and **S2**, any one **S1** of the spinous processes is disposed between the plurality of first support protrusions **114** in a state in which the outer surface of any one **S1** of the spinous processes is surrounded by the plurality of first support protrusions **114**. Therefore, the first support member **110** may be prevented from separating from any one **S1** of the spinous processes.

(24) The first frame **116** may be coupled to an inner portion of the first support body **112**. The first frame **116** may have a hollow cylindrical shape so that the first frame **116** may engage with the adjustment member **130** and accommodate the adjustment member **130**.

(25) The first frame **116** may be made of a material that is harmless to a human body and may be disinfected. For example, the first frame **116** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the first frame **116** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(26) The first frame **116** includes a first accommodation portion **116a** configured to accommodate one end **130a** of the adjustment member **130**, and a plurality of first teeth **116b** protruding from an inner surface of the first frame **116** toward the first accommodation portion **116a**. The plurality of first teeth **116b** is arranged in a direction in which the first support member **110** moves.

(27) The first teeth **116b** each have a first inclined surface **116b1** configured to define a first inclination angle $\theta 1$ with respect to the horizontal plane, and a second inclined surface **116b2** configured to define a second inclination angle $\theta 2$ with respect to the horizontal plane. The second inclination angle $\theta 2$ has a larger value than the first inclination angle $\theta 1$.

(28) The first insertion groove **118** has a shape concave from an outer surface of the first support body **112** toward an inner side of the first support body **112** so that a medical surgical instrument (not illustrated) such as Kelly forceps may be inserted and fixed into the first support body **112**. The first insertion groove **118** may have a circular shape, an elliptical shape, or a polygonal shape so that various tools such as medical forceps, pincers, medical drivers, or wrenches may be inserted into the first insertion groove **118**.

(29) The second support member **120** is configured to come into contact with at least a part of an outer surface of the other **S2** of the adjacent spinous processes. As illustrated in FIG. 1C, the second support member **120** may be configured to overlap the first support member **110**. The overlapping structure may serve as a guide that enables the support members **110** and **120** to move horizontally while moving away from each other and prevent rotational separation in which two opposite wings are twisted.

(30) The second support member **120** includes a second support body **122**, a plurality of second

support protrusions **124**, a second frame **126**, and a second insertion groove **128**.

(31) The second support body **122** may support the other S2 of the spinous processes in a state in which the endoscopic interspinous insert **100** is inserted between the adjacent spinous processes S1 and S2. The second support body **122** may be made of rubber or silicone. In addition, the second support body **122** may be made of various materials having an elastic force.

(32) The second support body **122** may include a second contact surface **122a** configured to come into contact with at least a part of the outer surface of the other S2 of the spinous processes.

(33) The second contact surface **122a** may have a shape corresponding to at least a part of the outer surface of the other S2 of the spinous processes. The second contact surface **122a** may have a mesh structure having relatively higher surface roughness than the other parts of the second support body **122**.

(34) Because the second contact surface **122a** has the mesh structure, a frictional force, which occurs when the second contact surface **122a** comes into contact with the spinous process S2, may prevent the second contact surface **122a** from slipping from the surface of the spinous process S2, such that the interspinous insert **100** may be stably fixed while being disposed between the spinous processes S1 and S2.

(35) The plurality of second support protrusions **124** protrudes from two opposite ends of the second support body **122**. Any one **124a** of the plurality of second support protrusions **124** may extend from one end of the second contact surface **122a**, and the other **124b** of the plurality of second support protrusions **124** may extend from the other end of the second contact surface **122a**.

(36) Because the plurality of first support protrusions **114** and the plurality of second support protrusions **124** are made of elastic materials such as sponge, rubber, or silicone, the interspinous insert **100** may be deformed in a streamlined shape, e.g., a shape of a bullet when the interspinous insert **100** is held by a medical surgical instrument (not illustrated) and the plurality of first support protrusions **114** and the plurality of second support protrusions **124** are pressed.

(37) Therefore, the interspinous insert **100** may pass through an incision hole (not illustrated) in a state in which the interspinous insert **100** is held by a medical surgical instrument (not illustrated) such as Kelly forceps and deformed in a streamlined shape as illustrated in FIG. 1A.

(38) The plurality of second support protrusions **124** may each have a rounded shape to surround the outer surface of the other S2 of the spinous processes. In the state in which the interspinous insert **100** is disposed between the spinous processes S1 and S2, the other S2 of the spinous processes is disposed between the plurality of second support protrusions **124** in a state in which the outer surface of the other S1 of the spinous processes is surrounded by the plurality of second support protrusions **124**. Therefore, the second support member **120** may be prevented from separating from the other S2 of the spinous processes.

(39) The second frame **126** may be coupled to the second support body **122**. The second frame **126** may have a hollow cylindrical shape so that the second frame **126** may engage with the adjustment member **130** and accommodate the adjustment member **130**.

(40) The second frame **126** may be made of a material that is harmless to a human body and may be disinfected. For example, the second frame **126** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the second frame **126** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(41) The second frame **126** includes a second accommodation portion **126a** configured to accommodate the other end **130b** of the adjustment member **130**, and a plurality of second teeth **126b** protruding from an inner surface of the second frame **126** toward the second accommodation portion **126a**. The plurality of second teeth **126b** is arranged in a direction in which the second support member **120** moves.

(42) The second teeth **126b** each have a third inclined surface **126b1** configured to define a third inclination angle θ_3 with respect to the horizontal plane, and a fourth inclined surface **126b2** configured to define a fourth inclination angle θ_4 with respect to the horizontal plane. The fourth

inclination angle $\theta 4$ has a larger value than the third inclination angle $\theta 3$. The third inclination angle $\theta 3$ may be equal to the first inclination angle θ , and the fourth inclination angle $\theta 4$ may be equal to the second inclination angle $\theta 2$.

(43) The plurality of first teeth **116b** and the plurality of second teeth **126b** collectively constitute frame side teeth.

(44) The second insertion groove **128** has a shape concave from an outer surface of the second support body **122** toward an inner side of the second support body **122** so that a medical surgical instrument may be inserted and fixed into the second support body **122**. The second insertion groove **128** may have a circular shape, an elliptical shape, or a polygonal shape so that various tools such as medical scissors, pincers, medical drivers, or wrenches may be inserted into the second insertion groove **128**.

(45) The adjustment member **130** is disposed between the first support member **110** and the second support member **120**. The adjustment member **130** is configured to adjust a distance between the first frame **116** and the second frame **126**.

(46) The adjustment member **130** includes a cylindrical adjustment body **132**, and a plurality of third teeth **134** and a plurality of fourth teeth **136** protruding from an outer peripheral surface of the adjustment body **132**. The plurality of third teeth **134** and the plurality of fourth teeth **136** collectively constitute adjustment side teeth. The adjustment member may be made of a material such as silicone, rubber, plastic material, or other synthetic metallic materials having elasticity and strength.

(47) The plurality of third teeth **134** respectively engages with the plurality of first teeth **116b**, and the plurality of fourth teeth **136** respectively engages with the plurality of second teeth **126b**.

(48) As described above, the first teeth **116b** each have the first inclined surface **116b1** configured to define the first inclination angle θ with respect to the horizontal plane, and the second inclined surface **116b2** configured to define the second inclination angle θ with respect to the horizontal plane, and the second inclination angle $\theta 2$ has a larger value than the first inclination angle $\theta 1$. Therefore, in the state in which the plurality of third teeth **134** respectively engages with the plurality of first teeth **116b**, the plurality of third teeth **134** may each move along the first inclined surface **116b1** having a relatively gradual inclination angle, but a movement of each of the plurality of third teeth **134** along the second inclined surface **116b2** having a relatively steep inclination angle is restricted.

(49) Likewise, the second teeth **126b** each have the third inclined surface **126b1** configured to define the third inclination angle $\theta 3$ with respect to the horizontal plane, and the fourth inclined surface **116b2** configured to define the fourth inclination angle $\theta 4$ with respect to the horizontal plane, and the fourth inclination angle $\theta 4$ has a large value than the third inclination angle $\theta 3$. Therefore, in the state in which the plurality of fourth teeth **136** respectively engages with the plurality of second teeth **126b**, the plurality of fourth teeth **136** may each move along the third inclined surface **126b1** having a relatively gradual inclination angle, but a movement of each of the plurality of fourth teeth **136** along the fourth inclined surface **126b2** having a relatively steep inclination angle is restricted.

(50) As illustrated in FIGS. 3A and 3B, a fastening structure between the adjustment member **130** and the first frame **116** and a fastening structure between the adjustment member **130** and the second frame **126** allow the first support member **110** to move only in a first direction a and allow the second support member **120** to move only in a second direction b opposite to the first direction a. That is, the first support member **110** and the second support member **120** only move in the direction in which the first support member **110** and the second support member **120** move away from each other.

(51) Hereinafter, a process of inserting and fixing the interspinous insert **100** between the spinous processes **S1** and **S2** will be described.

(52) Referring to FIG. 2A, the interspinous insert **100** may pass through the incision hole (not

illustrated) and be disposed between the spinous processes **S1** and **S2** in the state in which the interspinous insert **100** is held by the medical surgical instrument (not illustrated) and deformed in a streamlined shape. In this case, the first support member **110** and the second support member **120** of the interspinous insert **100** may overlap each other. A tool, such as medical forceps or pincers, capable of adjusting and decreasing a distance between two opposite ends thereof, may be used as the medical surgical instrument.

(53) Referring to FIGS. **2B**, **2C**, **3A**, and **3B**, when the interspinous insert **100** is released in the state in which the interspinous insert **100** is inserted between the spinous processes **S1** and **S2**, the plurality of first support protrusions **114** and the plurality of second support protrusions **124** protrude by the elastic force. Specifically, the plurality of first support protrusions **114** may protrude in the first direction **a**, and the plurality of second support protrusions **124** may protrude in the second direction **b**.

(54) Next, two opposite ends of a surgical tool (not illustrated) such as forceps are respectively inserted into the first insertion groove **118** and the second insertion groove **128**, and the two opposite ends of the surgical tool (not illustrated) inserted into the first insertion groove **118** and the second insertion groove **128** are moved away from each other. Therefore, the first support member **110** moves in the first direction **a**, and the second support member **120** moves in the second direction **b**, such that a distance between the first support member **110** and the second support member **120** increases. In this case, as described above, the fastening structure between the adjustment member **130** and the first frame **116** and the fastening structure between the adjustment member **130** and the second frame **126** restrict the movement of the first support member **110** in the second direction **b** and restrict the movement of the second support member **120** in the first direction **a**.

(55) When the first support member **110** and the second support member **120** are spaced apart from each other at a preset distance, the medical surgical instrument (not illustrated) may be separated from the first insertion groove **118** and the second insertion groove **128**. In this state, the first support member **110** and the second support member **120** may be respectively in contact with the spinous processes **S1** and **S2**.

(56) Although not illustrated, when the spinous processes **S1** and **S2** are tensely surrounded by a strap (not illustrated) in the state in which the interspinous insert **100** is inserted between the spinous processes **S1** and **S2**, the interspinous insert **100** is securely fixed between the spinous processes **S1** and **S2**, and the interspinous insert **100** is prevented from separating from the spinous processes. In addition, the stability of the corresponding spinal segment including the spinous processes **S1** and **S2** is significantly improved.

(57) The structure in which the first support member **110** and the second support member **120** are provided independently of the adjustment member **130** and coupled to the adjustment member **130** has been described above as an example. However, it is possible to adopt a structure in which the adjustment member **130** may be fixed to or integrated with any one of the first and second support members **110** and **120**, and only the other of the first and second support members **110** and **120** may move relative to the adjustment member **130**.

(58) In addition, the structure in which the adjustment member **130** has a cylindrical shape has been described as an example, but the present invention is not limited thereto. The shape of the adjustment member **130** and the hollow shapes of the frames may each be a polyhedral shape having a triangular or quadrangular cross-section. In this case, it is possible to adopt a structure in which the teeth configured to engage with the first frame **116** and the second frame **126** may be provided only one surface of the polyhedral shape.

(59) In addition, the present invention is not limited to the configuration in which the endoscopic interspinous insert **100** is inserted between the spinous processes of the vertebra. It is possible to adopt a structure in which the endoscopic interspinous insert **100** is inserted between bones existing in the body or between protrusions of other tissue.

(60) Hereinafter, an endoscopic interspinous insert **200** according to another embodiment of the present invention will be described. A description of parts identical to the above-mentioned parts of the endoscopic interspinous insert **100** according to the embodiment of the present invention will be omitted, and only parts different from the above-mentioned parts of the endoscopic interspinous insert **100** will be described.

(61) FIG. **4A** is a cross-sectional view of a first frame, a second frame, and an adjustment member of an endoscopic interspinous insert according to another embodiment of the present invention, and FIG. **4B** is a side view of the second frame and the adjustment member of the endoscopic interspinous insert according to the embodiment of the present invention. FIG. **4C** is a view illustrating a process of adjusting a distance between the first frame and the second frame.

(62) Referring to FIGS. **4A** and **4C**, a first frame **216** may have a hollow cylindrical shape to accommodate an adjustment member **230**.

(63) The first frame **216** includes a first accommodation portion **216a** configured to accommodate one end **230a** of the adjustment member **230**.

(64) The first frame **216** may be made of a material that is harmless to a human body and may be disinfected. For example, the first frame **216** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the first frame **216** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(65) A second frame **226** may have a hollow cylindrical shape to accommodate the adjustment member **230**.

(66) The second frame **226** includes a second accommodation portion **226a** configured to accommodate the other end **230b** of the adjustment member **230**.

(67) The second frame **226** may be made of a material that is harmless to a human body and may be disinfected. For example, the second frame **226** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the second frame **226** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(68) The adjustment member **230** is disposed between the first frame **216** and the second frame **226**.

(69) The adjustment member **230** may be configured as a cylindrical elastic body. Specifically, the adjustment member **230** may include a compression coil spring that resists against a compressive force. A resistive force of the compression coil spring against an external compressive force is proportional to a spring constant value (unit: N/mm) of the compression coil spring. This means that a distance between the first frame **216** and the second frame **226** may be adjusted depending on the spring constant value of the compression coil spring. Therefore, the distance between the first frame **216** and the second frame **226** may be adjusted by adjusting the spring constant value of the compression coil spring.

(70) One end **230a** of the adjustment member **230** is accommodated in the first accommodation portion **216a** of the first frame **216**, and the other end **230b** of the adjustment member **230** is accommodated in the second accommodation portion **226a** of the second frame **226**.

(71) One end **230a** of the adjustment member **230** is coupled and fixed to an inner surface of the first frame **216** in the state in which one end **230a** of the adjustment member **230** is accommodated in the first accommodation portion **216a** of the first frame **216**. The other end **230b** of the adjustment member **230** is coupled and fixed to an inner surface of the second frame **226** in the state in which the other end **230b** of the adjustment member **230** is accommodated in the second accommodation portion **226a** of the second frame **226**.

(72) A locking member **240** is configured to prevent the first frame **216** from separating from the second frame **226** and includes a hook **242** coupled to the first frame **216**, and a catching portion **244** extending from the second frame **226**.

(73) The hook **242** is provided to be tiltable and includes a catching protrusion **242a** protruding from one end thereof. The hook **242** mounted on a material having an elastic force that may return

the hook **242** to an original shape.

(74) The catching protrusion **242a** may be coupled to the catching portion **244** or separated from the catching portion **244** from the state in which the catching protrusion **242a** is coupled to the catching portion **244**.

(75) The catching portion **244** includes a plurality of catching holes **244a** so that the catching protrusion **242a** is inserted into and caught by the catching hole **244a**. The plurality of catching holes **244a** is disposed to be spaced apart from one another in a direction in which the adjustment member **230** is extended or compressed.

(76) When the catching protrusion **242a** is inserted into or caught by any one of the catching holes **244a**, the hook **242** is fixed to the catching portion **244**. When the hook **242** is fixed by being caught by the catching portion **244**, the first frame **216** is fixed to the second frame **226**.

(77) The locking member **240** may further include an inclined surface **246** concavely formed in the second frame **226**. The inclined surface **246** defines an accommodation space **246a** between the catching portion **244** and a part of the second frame **226**. One end of the hook **242** including the catching protrusion **242a** separated from any one of the catching holes **244a** is accommodated in the accommodation space **246a**. Therefore, one end of the hook **242** does not interfere with the second frame **226**.

(78) Hereinafter, a process of adjusting the distance between the first frame **216** and the second frame **226** will be described.

(79) Referring to FIGS. **4A** to **4C**, when a surgical tool **P** presses the catching protrusion **242a** caught by any one of the plurality of catching holes **244a**, the catching protrusion **242a** separates from any one of the plurality of catching holes **244a**. As illustrated in FIG. **4B**, the catching protrusion **242a** is disposed to be inclined, and the surgical tool **P** moves inclinedly and presses the catching protrusion **242a**.

(80) One end of the hook **242** including the catching protrusion **242a** separated from any one of the plurality of catching holes **244a** is accommodated in the accommodation space **246a**.

(81) When one end of the hook **242** is separated from any one of the plurality of catching holes **244a** and accommodated in the accommodation space **246a**, the first frame **216** becomes in an unlocked state in which the first frame **216** may freely move from the second frame **226**.

(82) In addition, because the elastic force of the adjustment member **230** presses the first frame **216** in the first direction **a** and presses the second frame **226** in the second direction **b**, the first frame **216** moves in the first direction **a** and the second support member **220** moves in the second direction **b** at the same time when the first frame **216** is unlocked.

(83) Once the catching protrusion **242a** is separated from the plurality of catching holes **244a**, the first frame **216** and the second frame **226** are moved away from each other by the elastic force of the adjustment member **230**. In this case, the separated catching protrusion **242a** may be moved by the elastic force of the adjustment member **230** and caught by another catching hole **244a** by the elastic force that returns the catching protrusion **242a** to an original shape. In the state in which the first frame **216** is spaced apart from the second frame **226**, the first frame **216** is fixed by the catching protrusion **242a** caught by another catching hole **244a**.

(84) The hook **242** and the catching portion **244** may each be made of a hard material so that the hook **242** and the catching portion **244** are not easily broken. Therefore, it is possible to prevent the hook **242** and the catching portion **244** from being damaged by a patient's motion such as when the patient repeatedly bends his/her waist. Therefore, it is possible to prevent the catching protrusion **242a** from separating from the catching hole **244a** or prevent the catching protrusion **242a** from colliding with the catching portion **244** and being broken.

(85) Hereinafter, an endoscopic interspinous insert **300** according to still another embodiment of the present invention will be described. A description of parts identical to the above-mentioned parts of the endoscopic interspinous insert **100** according to the embodiment of the present invention will be omitted, and only parts different from the above-mentioned parts of the

endoscopic interspinous insert **100** will be described.

(86) FIG. 5A is a cross-sectional view of a first frame, a second frame, and an adjustment member of an endoscopic interspinous insert according to still another embodiment of the present invention, and FIG. 5B is a side view of the second frame of the endoscopic interspinous insert according to the embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 5C is a view illustrating a process of adjusting a distance between the first frame and the second frame, and FIG. 5D is a view illustrating a state in which the first frame and the second frame are locked by a locking member.

(87) Referring to FIGS. 5A to 5D, a first frame **316** may have a hollow shape to accommodate a plurality of first teeth **316b** that engages with an adjustment member **330**.

(88) The first frame **316** may be made of a material that is harmless to a human body and may be disinfected. For example, the first frame **316** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the first frame **316** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(89) The first frame **316** includes a first accommodation portion **316a**, and the plurality of first teeth **316b** protruding from an inner surface of the first frame **316** toward the first accommodation portion **316a**. The plurality of first teeth **316b** is arranged in a direction in which the first frame **316** moves.

(90) A second frame **326** may have a hollow shape to accommodate a plurality of second teeth **326b** that engages with the adjustment member **330**.

(91) The second frame **326** may be made of a material that is harmless to a human body and may be disinfected. For example, the second frame **326** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the second frame **326** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(92) The second frame **326** includes a second accommodation portion **326a**, and a plurality of second teeth **326b** protruding from an inner surface of the second frame **326** toward the second accommodation portion **326a**. The plurality of second teeth **326b** is arranged in a direction in which the second support member **320** moves.

(93) The adjustment member **330** may have a shape of a gear that may engage with the plurality of first teeth **316b** and the plurality of second teeth **326b**. The adjustment member **330** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the adjustment member **330** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(94) The adjustment member **330** includes a locking groove **330a** to which a part of a locking member **350** to be described below is coupled. The locking groove **330a** is formed concavely from one side of the adjustment member **330** to an inner side of the adjustment member **330** so that a tool D such as a medical driver or a wrench may be inserted into the locking groove **330a**.

(95) When the tool D such as a medical driver or a wrench is inserted into the locking groove **330a** and applies torque, a rotational force is transmitted to the adjustment member **330**, such that the adjustment member **330** rotates. When the adjustment member **330** rotates, the plurality of first teeth **316b** and the plurality of second teeth **326b** engaging with the adjustment member **330** rectilinearly move in opposite directions and move the first frame **316** and the second frame **326**.

(96) In the present embodiment, the locking groove **330a** having a quadrangular shape has been illustrated and described, but the shape of the locking groove **330a** is not limited to the quadrangular shape. The locking groove **330a** may have various shapes such as a circular, elliptical, or polygonal shape in addition to the quadrangular shape.

(97) The adjustment member **330** further includes a circular insertion groove **340** into which a fixing screw **358** to be described below may be inserted.

(98) A screw thread (not illustrated) is formed on an inner surface of the insertion groove **340**. The fixing screw **358** to be described below may be coupled to the screw thread (not illustrated).

(99) The first frame **316** and the second frame **326** are always moved in the opposite directions by the structure in which the plurality of first teeth **316b** and the plurality of second teeth **326b** are

respectively disposed at upper and lower sides and engage with the adjustment member **330**. That is, the first frame **316** and the second frame **326** may move away from or toward each other depending on a rotation direction of the adjustment member **330**.

(100) The adjustment member **330** may be rotatably supported by a rotation support part (not illustrated) coupled to the other end of the adjustment member **330** opposite to one end of the adjustment member **330**.

(101) Hereinafter, a process of adjusting a distance between the first frame **316** and the second frame **326** and a process of locking the first frame **316** and the second frame **326** by using the locking member **350** to be described below will be described.

(102) Referring to FIGS. 5A to 5D, when the tool D such as a medical driver or a wrench is inserted into the locking groove **330a** of the adjustment member **330** and applies torque, the adjustment member **330** rotates, and the plurality of first teeth **316b** and the plurality of second teeth **326b** engaging with the adjustment member **330** respectively move in the first direction a and the second direction b, such that the distance between the first frame **316** and the second frame **326** increases. As illustrated in FIG. 5B, the tool D such as a medical driver or a wrench moves inclinedly and is coupled to the adjustment member **330**.

(103) In a state in which the first frame **316** and the second frame **326** are sufficiently spaced apart from each other, the locking member **350** is coupled to the first frame **316**, the second frame **326**, and the locking groove **330a**, the fixing screw **358** passes through a first through-hole **352b** of the first locking block **352** and a second through-hole **354b** of the second locking block **354**, and a screw thread **358c** of the fixing screw **358** is coupled to the screw thread (not illustrated) of the insertion groove **340**, such that the movements of the first and second frames **316** and **326** in the first direction a or the second direction b are restricted, and the first frame **316** and the second frame **326** may be locked.

(104) FIG. 6A is a front view illustrating the locking member, and FIG. 6B is a top plan view of a first locking block and a bottom plan view of a second locking block. FIG. 6C is a cross-sectional view illustrating the locking member, and FIG. 6D is a view illustrating a state in which the locking member and the adjustment member are coupled by the fixing screw.

(105) Referring to FIGS. 6A and 6C, the locking member **350** includes a first locking block **352**, a second locking block **354**, a connection flange **356**, and the fixing screw **358**. The locking member **350** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the locking member **350** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(106) The first locking block **352** has a hollow cylindrical shape to accommodate the fixing screw **358**, and a plurality of first teeth **352a** may be formed on an upper portion of the first locking block **352** and engage with a plurality of second teeth **354a** of the second locking block **354**. In addition, the first locking block **352** has the first through-hole **352b** and a first catching groove **352c**.

(107) The first through-hole **352b** is formed to accommodate a body **358b** of the fixing screw **358**, and the first through-hole **352b** communicates with the second through-hole **354b**.

(108) The first catching groove **352c** includes a first catching portion **352c1** configured to accommodate one end of the connection flange **356**, and a second catching portion **352c2** configured to accommodate a first protruding portion **356a** protruding and extending from one end of the connection flange **356**.

(109) The first catching portion **352c1** extends from one side of the second catching portion **352c2**. The first catching portion **352c1** communicates with a first catching portion **354c1** of a second catching groove **354c** of the second locking block **354**.

(110) The second catching portion **352c2** has a larger width than the first protruding portion **356a** of the connection flange **356**.

(111) The second locking block **354** has a hollow cylindrical shape to accommodate the fixing screw **358**, and the plurality of second teeth **354a** may be formed on a lower portion of the second

locking block **354** and engage with the plurality of first teeth **352a** of the first locking block **352**.
(112) In addition, the second locking block **354** has the second through-hole **354b** and the second catching groove **354c**.

(113) The second through-hole **354b** is formed to accommodate a head **358a** of the fixing screw **358**, and the second through-hole **354b** communicates with the first through-hole **352b**.

(114) The second catching groove **354c** includes the first catching portion **354c1** configured to accommodate the other end of the connection flange **356**, and a second catching portion **354c2** configured to accommodate a second protruding portion **356b** protruding and extending from the other end of the connection flange **356**.

(115) The first catching portion **354c1** extends from one side of the second catching portion **354c2**. The first catching portion **354c1** communicates with the first catching portion **352c1** of the first catching groove **352c** of the first locking block **352**.

(116) The second catching portion **354c2** has a larger width than the second protruding portion **356b** of the connection flange **356**.

(117) The connection flange **356** has a hollow cylindrical shape.

(118) The connection flange **356** is accommodated in the first catching groove **352c** of the first locking block **352** and the second catching groove **354c** of the second locking block **354**.

(119) The connection flange **356** includes the first protruding portion **356a** and the second protruding portion **356b**.

(120) The first protruding portion **356a** extends and protrudes from one end of the cylindrical connection flange **356** and is accommodated in the second catching portion **352c2** of the first catching groove **352c** of the first locking block **352**.

(121) The second protruding portion **356b** extends and protrudes from the other end of the cylindrical connection flange **356** and is accommodated in the second catching portion **354c2** of the second catching groove **354c** of the second locking block **354**.

(122) The fixing screw **358** may be accommodated in the first through-hole **352b** and the second through-hole **354b** and include the head **358a**, the body **358b**, and the screw thread **358c**.

(123) The head **358a** has a head shape of a flat head screw corresponding to a shape of the second through-hole **354b**.

(124) The body **358b** extends in a cylindrical shape from one end of the head **358a**.

(125) The screw thread **358c** may be formed at an end of the body **358b**, and the screw thread **358c** may be screw-coupled to the adjustment member **330**.

(126) Hereinafter, a process of locking the first frame **316** and the second frame **326** by using the locking member **350** will be described.

(127) FIG. **6D** is a view illustrating a state in which the locking member and the adjustment member are coupled by the fixing screw.

(128) Referring to FIG. **6D**, the locking member **350** and the fixing screw **358** are inserted and fixed between the first and second frames **316** and **326** between which the distance is adjusted by the adjustment member **330**. Therefore, the first frame **316** and the second frame **326** may be locked in the state in which the distance between the first frame **316** and the second frame **326** is maintained.

(129) More specifically, the first locking block **352** is coupled to the locking groove **330a** of the adjustment member **330** engaging with the first and second frames **316** and **326** between which the distance is maintained. The second locking block **354** is coupled between the first frame **316** and the second frame **326**.

(130) When the fixing screw **358** is inserted into and passes through the first through-hole **352b** and the second through-hole **354b** in the state in which the first locking block **352** and the second locking block **354** are coupled to each other, the screw thread **358c** of the fixing screw **358** comes into contact with the insertion groove **340** of the adjustment member **330**. In this state, when the fixing screw **358** is rotated by an adjustment tool (not illustrated) such as a driver or a wrench, the

screw thread **358c** moves along the screw thread **340a** formed on the insertion groove **340**, such that the fixing screw **358** is screw-coupled to the insertion groove **340**.

(131) During the process in which the fixing screw **358** is screw-coupled to the insertion groove **340**, the first locking block **352** and the second locking block **354** move toward each other, and the connection flange **356** moves in a direction in which the fixing screw **358** is inserted, such that the first protruding portion **356a** of the connection flange **356** moves to the second catching portion **352c2** of the first through-hole **352b**, and the second protruding portion **356b** moves to the second catching portion **354c2** of the second through-hole **354b**.

(132) Therefore, when the connection flange **356** moves, the second locking block **354** moves to the first locking block **352**, such that the plurality of first teeth **352a** and the plurality of second teeth **354a** engage with one another, and the relative rotation between the first and second locking blocks **352** and **354** is restricted.

(133) The first locking block **352** is inserted into the locking groove **330a** of the adjustment member **330**, and the second locking block **354** engaging with the first locking block **352** is inserted and fixed between the first frame **316** and the second frame **326**, as illustrated in FIG. 5D. Therefore, the relative rotation between the first and second locking blocks **352** and **354** is restricted, such that the rotation of the adjustment member **330** is restricted by the locking member **350**. Therefore, the first frame **316** and the second frame **326** may be locked in the state in which the first frame **316** and the second frame **326** are spaced apart from each other.

(134) Hereinafter, an endoscopic interspinous insert **400** according to yet another embodiment of the present invention will be described. A description of parts identical to the above-mentioned parts of the endoscopic interspinous insert **100** according to the embodiment of the present invention will be omitted, and only parts different from the above-mentioned parts of the endoscopic interspinous insert **100** will be described.

(135) FIG. 7A is a top plan view of a first frame, a second frame, and an adjustment member of an endoscopic interspinous insert according to yet another embodiment of the present invention. FIG. 7B is a side view of the first frame, the second frame, and the adjustment member of the endoscopic interspinous insert according to the embodiment of the present invention. FIGS. 7C and 7D are views illustrating a process of adjusting a distance between the first frame and the second frame.

(136) Referring to FIGS. 7A and 7B, a first frame **416** may have a hollow shape to accommodate an adjustment member **430**.

(137) The first frame **416** may be made of a material that is harmless to a human body and may be disinfected. For example, the first frame **416** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the first frame **416** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(138) The first frame **416** has a first accommodation portion **416a**.

(139) The first accommodation portion **416a** is formed to accommodate a screw **432ab** of a screw bevel gear **432a** of the adjustment member **430**.

(140) A second frame **426** may have a hollow shape to accommodate the first frame **416**.

(141) The second frame **426** may be made of a material that is harmless to a human body and may be disinfected. For example, the second frame **426** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the second frame **426** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(142) The second frame **426** includes a second accommodation portion **426a**, a third accommodation portion **426b**, and a fourth accommodation portion **426c**.

(143) The second accommodation portion **426a** is formed concavely inward to accommodate the first frame **416**.

(144) The third accommodation portion **426b** accommodates a head portion **432aa** of the screw bevel gear **432a** of the adjustment member **430**.

(145) The fourth accommodation portion **426c** accommodates an adjustment bevel gear **432b** of the adjustment member **430**.

(146) The adjustment member **430** is configured to adjust a distance between the first frame **416** and the second frame **426**.

(147) The adjustment member **430** is configured to transmit power and includes the screw bevel gear **432a** rotatably accommodated in the third accommodation portion **426b** of the second frame **426**, and the adjustment bevel gear **432b** rotatably accommodated in the fourth accommodation portion **426c** of the second frame **426**. The adjustment member **430** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the adjustment member **430** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(148) The screw bevel gear **432a** is configured to rotate while engaging with the adjustment bevel gear **432b**.

(149) The screw bevel gear **432a** includes the head **432aa** and the screw **432ab**.

(150) The head **432aa** may be rotatably supported in the third accommodation portion **426b**. The screw **432ab** may be rotatably supported at a predetermined position in the second accommodation portion **426a** of the second frame **426**.

(151) The adjustment bevel gear **432b** has an insertion groove **432b1** and a locking groove **432b2**.

(152) The insertion groove **432b1** is formed concavely from one end of the adjustment bevel gear **432b** to an inner side of the adjustment bevel gear **432b** and formed in a circular, elliptical, or polygonal shape. In addition, a screw thread (not illustrated) may be formed on an inner surface of the insertion groove **432b1** and coupled to the screw thread **358c** formed on the fixing screw **358** of the locking member **350**.

(153) When the screw thread **358c** provided on the locking member **350** is coupled to the screw thread (not illustrated) of the insertion groove **432b1**, the first frame **416** may be locked in a state in which the first frame **416** is spaced apart from the second frame **426**.

(154) The locking groove **432b2** is provided at the other end of the adjustment bevel gear **432b** and has an elliptical or polygonal shape so that various tools such as a medical driver or a wrench may be inserted.

(155) The locking groove **432b2** is formed concavely from the other end of the adjustment bevel gear **432b** to the inner side of the adjustment bevel gear **432b** and formed in a polygonal or elliptical shape. When the tool such as a medical driver or a wrench is inserted into the locking groove **432b2** and applies torque, a rotational force is transmitted to the adjustment bevel gear **432b**, such that the adjustment bevel gear **432b** rotates, and the screw bevel gear **432a** engaging with the adjustment bevel gear **432b** rotates.

(156) When the screw bevel gear **432a** rotates, the first frame **416** moves in the first direction a or a direction opposite to the first direction a, such that the distance between the first frame **416** and the second frame **426** may be adjusted.

(157) Hereinafter, a process of adjusting the distance between the first frame **416** and the second frame **426** and a process of locking the first frame **416** and the second frame **426** by using the locking member **350** will be described.

(158) Referring to FIGS. 7A and 7B, when the tool (not illustrated) such as a medical driver or a wrench is inserted into the locking groove **432b2** of the adjustment bevel gear **432b** and applies torque, the adjustment bevel gear **432b** rotates in one direction. When the adjustment bevel gear **432b** rotates in one direction, the screw bevel gear **432a** engaging with the adjustment bevel gear **432b** rotates. When the screw bevel gear **432a** rotates, the first frame **416** engaging with the screw **432ab** of the screw bevel gear **432a** moves in the first direction a, such that the distance between the first frame **416** and the second frame **426** increases.

(159) In the state in which the first frame **416** and the second frame **426** are sufficiently spaced apart from each other, the tool (not illustrated) such as a medical driver or a wrench is separated from the locking groove **432b2** of the adjustment bevel gear **432b**, the first locking block **352** of the

locking member **350** is coupled to the locking groove **432b2**, and the second locking block **354** of the locking member **350** is coupled to the fourth accommodation portion **426c** of the adjustment bevel gear **432b**.

(160) When the fixing screw **358** is inserted into and passes through the first through-hole **352b** of the first locking block **352** and the second through-hole **354b** of the second locking block **354** in the state in which the first locking block **352** and the second locking block **354** are loosely coupled by the connection flange **356**, the screw thread **358c** of the fixing screw **358** comes into contact with the insertion groove **432b1** of the adjustment bevel gear **432b**. In this state, when the fixing screw **358** is rotated by an adjustment tool (not illustrated) such as a driver or a wrench, the screw thread **358c** of the fixing screw **358** moves along the screw thread (not illustrated) formed on the insertion groove **432b1**, such that the fixing screw **358** is screw-coupled to the insertion groove **432b1**.

(161) During the process in which the fixing screw **358** is screw-coupled to the insertion groove **432b1**, the first locking block **352** and the second locking block **354** move toward each other, and the connection flange **356** moves in a direction in which the fixing screw **358** is inserted, such that the first protruding portion **356a** of the connection flange **356** moves to the second catching portion **352c2** of the first through-hole **352b**, and the second protruding portion **356b** moves to the second catching portion **354c2** of the second through-hole **354b**.

(162) Therefore, when the connection flange **356** moves, the second locking block **354** moves toward the first locking block **352**, such that the plurality of first teeth **352a** and the plurality of second teeth **354a** engage with one another, and the relative rotation between the first and second locking blocks **352** and **354** is restricted.

(163) The first locking block **352** is fixed to the adjustment bevel gear **432b**, and the second locking block **354** engaging with the first locking block **352** is coupled and fixed to the fourth accommodation portion **426c**. Therefore, the relative rotation between the first locking block **352** and the second locking block **354** is restricted, such that the rotation of the adjustment bevel gear **432b** is restricted by the locking member **350**. In addition, the rotation of the screw bevel gear **432a** engaging with the adjustment bevel gear **432b** is restricted. Therefore, the first frame **416** may be locked in the state in which the first frame **416** is spaced apart from the second frame **426**.

(164) Thereafter, when the distance between the first frame **416** and the second frame **426** is required to be adjusted, the fixing screw **358** is separated, the locking member (not illustrated) inserted and fixed into the locking groove **432b2** of the adjustment bevel gear **432b** and the fourth accommodation portion **426c** of the second frame is separated, and then the adjustment bevel gear **432b** is rotated by the tool (not illustrated) such as a medical driver or a wrench, such that the distance between the first frame **416** and the second frame **426** may be adjusted.

(165) Hereinafter, an endoscopic interspinous insert **500** according to still yet another embodiment of the present invention will be described. A description of parts identical to the above-mentioned parts of the endoscopic interspinous insert **100** according to the embodiment of the present invention will be omitted, and only parts different from the above-mentioned parts of the endoscopic interspinous insert **100** will be described.

(166) FIG. **8A** is a top plan view of a first frame, a second frame, and an adjustment member of an endoscopic interspinous insert according to still yet another embodiment of the present invention. FIG. **8B** is a side view of the second frame of the endoscopic interspinous insert according to the embodiment of the present invention. FIG. **8C** is a cross-sectional view taken along line C-C in FIG. **8A**. FIG. **8D** is a view illustrating a process of adjusting a distance between the first frame and the second frame.

(167) Referring to FIGS. **8A** to **8D**, a first frame **516** may have a hollow shape so that the first frame **516** may be coupled to a second frame **526**.

(168) The first frame **516** may be made of a material that is harmless to a human body and may be disinfected. For example, the first frame **516** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless

steel or a plastic material. In addition, the first frame **516** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(169) The first frame **516** includes a first adjustment groove **516a** and a first accommodation groove **516b**.

(170) The first adjustment groove **516a** is formed at one end of the first frame **516** and includes a screw thread provided on an outer peripheral surface thereof. The first adjustment groove **516a** is coupled to the second adjustment groove **526a** to define a conical shape. That is, the first adjustment groove **516a** has a shape having a diameter that gradually decreases in a direction in which the adjustment member **530** is inserted.

(171) The first accommodation groove **516b** is angled and formed concavely inward from above to accommodate one end of the second locking block **354** of the locking member **350**.

(172) The second frame **526** may have a hollow shape so that the second frame **526** may be coupled to the first frame **516**.

(173) The second frame **526** may be made of a material that is harmless to a human body and may be disinfected. For example, the second frame **526** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the second frame **526** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(174) The second frame **526** includes a second adjustment groove **526a** and a second accommodation groove **526b**.

(175) The second adjustment groove **526a** is formed at one end of the second frame **526** and includes a screw thread formed on an outer peripheral surface thereof. The second adjustment groove **526a** is coupled to the first adjustment groove **516a** to define the conical shape. That is, the second adjustment groove **526a** has a shape having a diameter that gradually decreases in the direction in which the adjustment member **530** is inserted.

(176) The second accommodation groove **526b** is angled and formed concavely inward from above to accommodate the other end of the second locking block **354** of the locking member **350**.

(177) The adjustment member **530** is disposed between the first adjustment groove **516a** and the second adjustment groove **526a** and has a wedge shape.

(178) The adjustment member **530** includes an insertion groove **530a**, a locking groove **530b**, and an adjustment screw thread **532**. The adjustment member **530** may be made of a metallic material such as stainless steel or a plastic material. In addition, the adjustment member **530** may be made of various materials having rigidity and high corrosion resistance.

(179) The insertion groove **530a** is angled and formed concavely from one side of the adjustment member **530** to an inner side of the adjustment member **530** so that various tools such as a medical driver or a wrench may be inserted into the insertion groove **530a**.

(180) When the tool such as a medical driver or a wrench is inserted into the insertion groove **530a** and applies torque, a rotational force is transmitted to the adjustment member **530**, such that the adjustment member **530** rotates. When the adjustment member **530** rotates, the distance between the first and second frames **516** and **526** screw-coupled to the adjustment member **530** increases, and the first frame **516** and the second frame **526** are moved.

(181) In the present embodiment, the insertion groove **530a** having a quadrangular shape has been illustrated and described, but the shape of the insertion groove **530a** is not limited to the quadrangular shape. The insertion groove **530a** may have various shapes such as a circular, elliptical, or polygonal shape in addition to the quadrangular shape.

(182) The locking groove **530b** has an elliptical or polygonal shape so that various tools such as a medical driver or a wrench may be inserted into the locking groove **530b**. In addition, a screw thread (not illustrated) is formed in the locking groove **530b**. The screw thread **358c** of the fixing screw **358** may be coupled to the screw thread (not illustrated).

(183) The adjustment screw thread **532** may be provided on the outer peripheral surface of the adjustment member **530** and screw-coupled to the first adjustment groove **516a** and the second

adjustment groove **526a**.

(184) Hereinafter, a process of adjusting a distance between the first frame **516** and the second frame **526** and a process of locking the first frame **516** and the second frame **526** by using the locking member **350** will be described.

(185) Referring to FIGS. **8A** to **8D**, when the tool (not illustrated) such as a medical driver or a wrench is inserted into the insertion groove **530a** of the adjustment member **530** and applies torque, the adjustment screw thread **532** rotates in one direction, and the adjustment member **530** moves to a deep portion between the first frame **516** and the second frame **526**. Therefore, the first frame **516** and the second frame **526** move away from each other, the first frame **516** moves in the first direction **a**, and the second frame **526** moves in the second direction **b**, such that the distance between the first frame **516** and the second frame **526** increases.

(186) In a state in which the first frame **516** and the second frame **526** are sufficiently spaced apart from each other, the locking member **350** is coupled to the first frame **516**, the second frame **526**, and the insertion groove **530a**, the fixing screw **358** passes through the first through-hole **352b** of the first locking block **352** and the second through-hole **354b** of the second locking block **354**, and the screw thread **358c** of the fixing screw **358** is coupled to the screw thread (not illustrated) of the locking groove **530b**, such that the movements of the first and second frames **516** and **526** in the first direction **a** or the second direction **b** are restricted, and the first frame **516** and the second frame **526** may be locked.

(187) Thereafter, when the distance between the first frame **516** and the second frame **526** is required to be adjusted in accordance with states of the spinous processes **S1** and **S2**, the locking member **350** inserted and fixed into the insertion groove **530a** is separated, and then the adjustment member **530** is rotated by the tool such as a medical driver or a wrench, such that the distance between the first frame **516** and the second frame **526** may be adjusted.

(188) Each of the endoscopic interspinous inserts **100**, **200**, **300**, **400**, and **500** may further include a pressure sensor (not illustrated) and a communication module (not illustrated). The pressure sensor may sense a pressure of each of the endoscopic interspinous inserts **100**, **200**, **300**, **400**, and **500** inserted between the spinous processes. The communication module may be electromagnetically connected to the pressure sensor and transmit an electrical signal, which is received from the pressure sensor, to a device such as an external server or a user terminal through wireless communication.

(189) While the exemplary embodiments of the present invention have been illustrated and described above, the present invention is not limited to the specific exemplary embodiments, and various modifications can of course be made by those skilled in the art to which the present invention pertains without departing from the subject matter of the present invention as claimed in the claims. Further, the modifications should not be appreciated individually from the technical spirit or prospect of the present invention.

Claims

1. An endoscopic interspinous insert, which is configured to be inserted between adjacent spinous processes, the endoscopic interspinous insert comprising: a first support member comprising a first support body configured to support one of the adjacent spinous processes, a plurality of first support protrusions protruding from two opposite ends of the first support body, and a first frame disposed inside the first support body; a second support member comprising a second support body configured to support the other of the adjacent spinous processes, a plurality of second support protrusions protruding from two opposite ends of the second support body, and a second frame disposed inside the second support body; an adjustment member disposed between the first support member and the second support member and configured to adjust a distance between the first support member and the second support member, the adjustment member comprising a screw bevel

gear rotatably disposed inside the second frame and coupled to the first support member, and an adjustment bevel gear configured to transmit power to the screw bevel gear; and a locking member configured to maintain the distance between the first support member and the second support member and to restrict movement of the first support member and the second support member, wherein the locking member is coupled to the adjustment bevel gear and the second frame to restrict rotation of the adjustment bevel gear.

2. The endoscopic interspinous insert of claim 1, wherein each of the plurality of first support protrusions protrudes from the first support body in a first direction, wherein each of the plurality of second support protrusions protrudes from the second support body in a second direction opposite to the first direction, and wherein the locking member is further configured to restrict movement of the first support member in the second direction and to restrict movement of the second support member in the first direction.

3. The endoscopic interspinous insert of claim 1, wherein the locking member includes a first locking block inserted into the adjustment member and a second locking block inserted between the first support member and the second support member, and wherein the locking member is further configured to restrict the rotation of the adjustment bevel gear by restricting the relative rotation between the first locking block and the second locking block.
